Aotearoa: Two Cultures, One Nation

Explore how Māori culture shapes modern New Zealand.



Two symbols can carry different histories and meanings.

Why are there two flags?





Key word: bicultural



bicultural

two different cultures living together in one society



treaty

a formal agreement between groups



ancestral

connected with ancestors



indigenous

the original inhabitants of a land



preserve

keep something safe over time



artifact

a human-made object with cultural or historical value

AOTEAROA

What does biculturalism mean in Aotearoa?

New Zealand is often called Aotearoa, “the land of the long white cloud.”

It is a bicultural nation: Māori culture is an official part of modern life, not only a historical artifact.

HISTORY AND RESPONSIBILITY

The Treaty of Waitangi still matters

Read the text and find details that support each point.

01

Signed in 1840

Signed in 1840 between Māori and the British Crown.

02

Promised protection

Promised to protect Māori land, culture, and language.

03

A complex history

The history is complex, with conflicts over land.

Te reo Māori: a living language

Why is language important for national identity?

Since 1987	Māori has been an official language alongside English.
In schools	You can hear te reo Māori in schools.
On television	You can hear te reo Māori on television.
In place names	You can see it in place names such as Whangārei and Rotorua.

CULTURE IN PUBLIC LIFE

Culture you can see and hear

Haka

A traditional war dance performed by the All Blacks before international rugby games; it expresses strength and unity.

Marae

A traditional meeting house where carvings and artifacts tell tribal stories.





What does the haka show?

Why might a war dance be performed before a sports game?

What does this tell us about culture, identity, strength, and unity?

From my point of view…

I see your point, but…

GROUP DISCUSSION

Dialogue of cultures

In groups, compare New Zealand's approach to Māori culture with the approach to indigenous cultures in your country.



Protection

How is indigenous culture protected?



Public life

How is it celebrated in public life?



Learning

What could countries learn from one another?

In my country, for example…

REFLECT AND EXTEND

Exit ticket and homework



Exit ticket

Why is Te Reo Maori important for New Zealand’s identity?



Homework

Write 50 words on “What can other countries learn from New Zealand’s approach to indigenous culture?”